grants for centrally sponsored schemes implemented at the state level. According to a research paper by the New Delhi-based not-for-profit Health Systems Transformation Platform (HSTP), the key reasons for under-spending on healthcare are a weak health system, human resource constraints, governance issues and a complex process of procurement and construction.

Another reason is the time taken for the funds to reach the districts after being received by the states from the Centre. 'Delays occur in the transfer of funds from the treasury to the National Health Mission head office and in fund transfers from the headquarters to district health societies, which have multiple bank accounts. This affects transparency and complicates the tracking of funds,' states an April 2021 paper by Sudha Chandrashekar of HSTP and Sarit K. Rout of the Indian Institute of Public Health, Bhubaneswar.

The Jal Shakti ministry had till November spent only 34 per cent of what was earmarked for the financial year; it had spent 44 per cent in the corresponding period in the previous financial year. This when the ministry, under the Jal Jeevan Mission, is chasing an ambitious target of providing drinking water to all rural households by 2024. Of the estimated 189 million rural households, only 17 per cent had some version of tap water connection as on August 2021. The Jal Jeevan Mission outlay has been estimated at Rs 3.6 lakh crore, of which Rs 2.08 lakh crore is the central government's share. Chatterjee is of the view that despite the constraints, the Jal Jeevan Mission has made commendable progress.

But to speed up implementation, Chatterjee advocates aggressive efforts to rope in corporations, trusts, and Indian and overseas foundations, who may wish to participate by adopting a cluster of villages. "The evolution of *pani samitis* into local water utilities can be widened to include electricity, public health and education," says Chatterjee. Meanwhile, of what was budgeted for 2021-22, the ministry of agriculture had spent only about half the sum till November, the AYUSH ministry 51 per cent, the coal ministry 60 per cent and the communications and education ministries 53 and 48 per cent, respectively (see *Tripping on Execution*).

On the revenue side, the government, till November, had achieved nearly 70 per cent of the targeted revenues for the financial year (Rs 13.7 lakh crore out of the total targeted receipts of Rs 19.7 lakh crore). Of the targeted tax revenues of Rs 15.4 lakh crore, it had achieved Rs 11.3 lakh crore. In November, the Centre re-

TRIPPING ON EXECUTION

Shortfall in expenditure by central ministries in 2021-22

MINISTRY	FY2021-22		% OF ACTUALS COMPARED TO BE	
	BUDGET ESTIMATE (BE)	ACTUALS (TILL NOV. 2021)	CURRENT	LAST FY
Agriculture & Farmer's Welfare	1,31,531.19	66,409.12	**50%**	52%
AYUSH	2,970.3	1,524.06	**51%**	58%
Coal	534.88	323.41	**60%**	38%
Communications	75,265.22	40,040.16	**53%**	61%
Defence	4,78,195.62	3,17,438.28	**66%**	63%
Education	93,224.31	44,285.23	**48%**	41%
Electronics & IT	9,720.66	3,294.94	**34%**	40%
Environment, Forests & Climate Change	2,869.93	954.78	**33%**	44%
Health & Family Welfare	73,931.77	47,006.01	**64%**	74%
Jal Shakti	69,053.02	23,751.66	**34%**	44%
MSME	15,699.65	9,874.43	**63%**	31%
Power	15,322	6,056.47	**40%**	35%
Road Transport & Highways	1,18,101	80,567.68	**68%**	65%
Textiles	3,631.64	1,747.8	**48%**	45%
Tourism	2,026.77	268.51	**13%**	33%

Figures in Rs crore; Source: Controller General of Accounts

"THE SPENDING GAP CAN BE ATTRIBUTED TO THE DISRUPTIONS DUE TO COVID. SO MANY WORKERS REPORTED SICK, WHICH DELAYED PROJECTS"

– VINAYAK CHATTERJEE
Chairman, Feedback Ventures

